

Daily Bible Note

Date: October 3, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 18:1-8

1 After this it came to pass that David attacked the Philistines, subdued them, and took Gath and its towns from the hand of the Philistines.

2 Then he defeated Moab, and the Moabites became David's servants, and brought tribute.

3 And David defeated Hadadezer king of Zobah as far as Hamath, as he went to establish his power by the River Euphrates.

4 David took from him one thousand chariots, seven thousand horsemen, and twenty thousand foot soldiers. Also David hamstringed all the chariot horses, except that he spared enough of them for one hundred chariots.

5 When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David killed twenty-two thousand of the Syrians.

6 Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus; and the Syrians became David's servants, and brought tribute. So the Lord preserved David wherever he went.

7 And David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.

8 Also from Tibhath and from Chun, cities of Hadadezer, David brought a large amount of bronze, with which Solomon made the bronze Sea, the pillars, and the articles of bronze.

II. Key Summary

- David went on the offensive, struck the Philistines and took Gath and its towns, then defeated Moab, and the Moabites became his servants and brought tribute (vv. 1-2).

- David defeated Hadadezer king of Zobah and took one thousand chariots, seven thousand horsemen, and twenty thousand foot soldiers, yet he hamstrung all the chariot

horses and kept only enough for one hundred chariots (vv. 3-4).

- David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus, and the text says, "So the LORD preserved David wherever he went"; he brought the gold shields to Jerusalem, and the bronze he took was later used by Solomon for the bronze Sea, the pillars, and the articles of bronze (vv. 5-8).

III. Passage Analysis

Every Victory Was God's

David took what was the glory of the enemy and transformed it into trophies of the power and goodness of God. David displayed those shields of gold, testifying to God's work in and through David. [1]

Those gold shields were the enemy's pride, and David hung them up in Jerusalem as evidence of what God had done — not as a brag about his own record. Win after win, the passage keeps pointing past David to the One who "preserved David wherever he went."

He Got Rid of What He Could Have Leaned On

A horse is a vain thing for safety, so David said, and it seems he believed what he said, for he houghed the chariot-horses. [2]

David had already written that horses can't save anyone — and then a thousand chariots landed in his hands and he crippled almost all of them. Saying you trust God and living like you trust God are two different things, and here David did the second one.

IV. Reflection Question

When was the last time you won something — a game, a test, a project you finally got done? Looking back at that win, where do you think it came from?

David won battle after battle, and the only conclusion the text gives is one line: "So the LORD preserved David wherever he went" — not one of those victories was something he pulled off on his own.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 18 – The Security of David's Kingdom",
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-18/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary on 1 Chronicles 18,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1ch/1ch_018.cfm